



ASEAN Amazing Weaves Exhibition Concept Note

A Multi-Stakeholder Collaboration to Revitalize Indigenous Weaving and Women's Economic Empowerment

Summary

Building on the pathways of the national program LIKHA from protection and innovation of cultural heritage, co-creation with local artisans, designers and manufacturers to a shared market, the Amazing weaves is a multi-stakeholder initiative is a celebration of Philippines and ASEAN craftsmanship from indigenous weaving, clothing and fashion to home décor, lifestyle pieces, and other product applications where weaving becomes an essential design or material component. The initiative aims to elevate traditional textiles enlivening the stories of courtship, harvest, war, healing, and spirituality into modern pattern design and market-ready products across various creative sectors. In parallel, the Philippine commission on Women (PCW) will guide the application of gender inclusion and accessibility lens into the design of the weaving program enabling LGUs to utilize their mandatory 5% GAD budget to fund weaving hubs, skills upgrading and product innovation directly to sustainable livelihoods, MSME development and local economic recovery. Through the effective platform of Galing Pook, our partnership will promote integrated governance, gender strategy and women's economic empowerment, that supports LGU shared goals, excellence in local governance through recognition, sharing of information and support of efforts to replicate best practices at the local level, LGUs will champion a holistic development model where artisans, thrive as a cultural bearers, innovators and economic leaders.

This will culminate in the ASEAN Women Economic Summit (AWES) Philippines 2026, a high-level regional summit that advances women's leadership, economic integration, and inclusive growth across ASEAN and deepening commitments by strengthening regional collaboration, advancing inclusive markets and recognizing outstanding contributions of ASEAN women in economic development. This summit aligns with ASEAN Gender Mainstreaming Strategy, ASEAN Economic Community Blueprint 2025 and regional

priorities on Green Economic Development, digital innovation, climate smart MSMEs and women's leadership in sustainable value chains.

Background

The **ASEAN Amazing Weaves Exhibition (AWE)**, stemming from a Philippine national competition, is conceived to be an ASEAN regional platform to honor excellence and pride in the weaving traditions of indigenous weaving communities, celebrate ASEAN craftsmanship, and strengthen collaboration among public and private sectors of ASEAN with their local weaving communities.

The Exhibition will be held during the Philippines' ASEAN Chairship in 2026, under the auspices of the ASEAN National Organizing Council (NOC) as created through Administrative Order No. 17. ASEAN AWE aims to showcase indigenous creativity and foster each ASEAN community's unique identity as a form of empowerment, innovation, and diplomacy, as part of the ASEAN Women's Engagement Roadmap. It aims to showcase indigenous creativity as a powerful vehicle for women's empowerment, innovation, and diplomacy. Weaving serves both as a livelihood and as a cultural identity marker, deeply integrated into family life and rural community traditions.

At the national level, this vision strongly complemented by LIKHA an artisanal exhibit and flagship initiative of First Lady Liza Araneta-Marcos that elevates Filipino craftsmanship and protects cultural heritage by bringing local artisans, designers and manufacturers into shared space of creativity, capacity building, and market access. The program has paved pathways from innovation, co-creation to market access.

LIKHA has showcased innovations in Philippine Tropical Fabrics (PTFs)—abaca, pineapple leaf, and bamboo fibers developed by DOST-PTRI—while spotlighting master artisans such as Ilokano designer Amor Albano, who presented Inabel creations woven by GAMABA awardees. Filipino textiles continue to gain recognition globally, from the looms of Aklan to exhibitions in Rome, demonstrating how heritage crafts can serve as soft power and cultural diplomacy. These efforts parallel community-grounded development programs, through DOST's interventions and customized MSME coaching, women entrepreneurs gain improved production, technological support, financial literacy, and expanded market pathways, proof of government's commitment to sustainable rural industries. This broader ecosystem of weaving diplomacy also connects to ASEAN's regional narrative. Encounters such as meeting 2015 Ramon Magsaysay Awardee Mrs. Kommalay Chanthavong and learning from Laos' storied silk traditions underscore the deep regional heritage ties that Amazing Weaves seeks to amplify. Building on these linkages, the platform aspires to position indigenous textiles as instruments of women's leadership, cultural exchange, and regenerative local industries across ASEAN.

Together, Amazing Weaves and LIKHA form a united movement, national in identity and regional in purpose, celebrating indigenous excellence, strengthening women-led MSMEs, and elevating Philippine and ASEAN weaving traditions onto the global stage and pave the way to cultural empowerment and governance, heritage policy, and

community development strategies to sustain the craft amid economic and generational change.

Galing Likha is a national recognition program launched in **September 2024** as a collaborative initiative led by the Galing Pook Foundation, in partnership with **WomenBizPH**, **DTI**, **PCW**, and other key agencies and stakeholders. The program was developed to honor outstanding local government units (LGUs) that have successfully integrated **cultural heritage preservation**, **inclusive innovation**, and **gender-responsive entrepreneurship** into their governance and development strategies.

Inspired by the need to link culture with commerce, Galing Likha builds on the legacy of **Galing Pook's excellence in local governance awards**, extending its scope to recognize LGUs that empower artisans, women-led enterprises, and creative communities. It highlights how weaving, traditional crafts, and indigenous knowledge systems can drive economic development, tourism, and social inclusion when backed by enabling local policies and GAD funding. The inaugural cycle of Galing Likha served as a preparatory platform for LGUs participating in **ASEAN 2026**, aligning local innovation with global cultural and sustainability goals.

PCW supports the localization of the Magna Carta of Women, enabling LGUs to integrate gender equality into planning, budgeting, and service delivery. Through the partnership with Philippine Commission on Women, WomenBizPH will provide guidance in the application of Harmonized Gender and Development using Community Development and Basic Strategic Planning principles. Project Management Monitoring and Evaluation. This collaboration ensures that LGUs become drivers of inclusive growth, where women are empowered as leaders, innovators, and economic contributors in their local economies.

Galing Pook works closely with Local Government Units (LGUs) to promote excellence, innovation, and inclusive governance through its flagship awards and capacity-building program. By recognizing and documenting outstanding local initiatives, Galing Pook encourages LGUs to replicate and scale best practices that empower communities, especially women, youth, and marginalized groups. Through the effective platform of Galing Pook, our partnership will promote integrated governance, gender strategy and women's economic empowerment, that supports LGU shared goals, excellence in local governance through recognition, sharing of information and support of efforts to replicate best practices.

Key Principles of ASEAN Amazing Weaves Awards

Purpose

- Celebrate ASEAN craftsmanship and cultural identity, particularly through indigenous textile weaving in Fashion, Accessories and Home Décor or Home Furnishings among and lifestyle pieces
- Preserving narratives of weaving traditions among ASEAN member states, and at the same time, encouraging novel and innovative expressions of culture and creativity, in rendition, or in the use of new materials or technology
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creativity, in rendition, or in the use of new materials or technology. It will provide a new platform to tell the communities stories of courtship, harvest, war, healing, and spirituality.

- Address the threats of fast fashion, appropriation, and cultural erosion within ASEAN.

Vision: A thriving Philippines and ASEAN where indigenous weaving traditions and women artisans flourish as cultural bearers, creative innovators, and economic leaders, supported by integrated governance, inclusive markets, and gender-responsive development systems that promote sustainable livelihoods, MSME growth, and cultural resilience.

Core Objectives:

1. **Protect and Elevate Cultural Heritage** by strengthening the documentation of preservation and innovation of indigenous textiles, techniques, and narratives of weaving as a key input in fashion, home décor, lifestyle, hospitality, architecture, and product design. Recognize ASEAN best practices that sustain and empower weaving communities.
2. **Build Market Pathways and Creative Industry Integration** by building on the LIKHA program's pathway from protection, innovation, co-creation to market integration. Equip ASEAN weavers for global markets through marketing and business development and connect artisans and MSMEs to national and ASEAN/global markets.
3. **Empower Women Artisans and MSMEs by** upskilling and modernizing weaving practices in ASEAN across weaving communities with support from design institutions and Showcasing the work of ASEAN weavers, and present the inaugural national Amazing Weaves Awardees at the ASEAN Pavillion during the ASEAN Women Economic Summit (AWES) Philippines 2026.
4. **Promote Integrated Governance and Gender Inclusion by guiding** LGUs in applying PCW's Harmonized Gender and Development Guidelines (HGDG) and help in mobilizing the 5% GAD budget for weaving hubs, training, innovation labs, and community enterprises and recognize LGU leadership through Galing Pook's governance excellence and replicable best practices.
5. **Foster Multi-Stakeholder Collaboration** by fostering platforms for public-private models for scalable innovation and enterprise initiatives across ASEAN. Unite government, private sector, designers, academe, and communities in a shared ecosystem for sustainable creative industries. Collaborate with AWEN, ASEAN BAC, ACCMSME, and cultural and design councils to expand cross-border opportunities. Set the foundation for establishing the ASEAN Hub of Excellence for Women Empowerment and Gender Equality (ASEAN GAD Center) in the Philippines and ASEAN Women Business Council

Criteria

A. Cultural Integrity and Indigenous Techniques

- Use of traditional and indigenous weaving techniques (e.g. backstrap loom, ikat, binakol, inaul, hablon, tepina, pis syabit)
- Respectful representation of cultural symbols and narratives (e.g. courtship, harvest, spiritual patterns, ethnic identities)
- Collaboration with or direct creation by cultural bearers or communities
- Documentation of origin, process, and meaning, aligned with NCCA and GAMABA values

B. Textile-Centered Design and Functionality

- Weaving or handwoven textile must be a dominant design or structural component
(e.g. not just an accent or trim, but central to the item's identity)
- Applies to categories such as:
 - Fashion (wearable art, terno, streetwear, accessories)
 - Interior (upholstery, wall art, curtains, rugs)
 - Lifestyle (bags, home décor, footwear, tech accessories)
 - Demonstrates innovative or functional adaptation of traditional textiles for modern use

C. Regenerative and Inclusive Entrepreneurship

- Embeds regenerative business practices, such as:
- Circularity (repairable, recyclable, modular design)
- Use of low-impact or natural dyes, sustainable fibers (e.g. abaca, pineapple, bamboo, cotton, tikog)
- Ethical labor and inclusive community engagement
Prioritizes women-led, youth-led, or indigenous community-based enterprises
Contributes to long-term livelihood, knowledge transmission, and local value

chains

D. Climate-Resilient and Sustainable Supply Chains

- Evidence of climate-smart practices:
- Fiber sourcing from climate-resilient crops
- Adaptive production methods (e.g. off-grid, solar-powered, seasonal or rotational production)
 - o Reduction of environmental footprint in sourcing, packaging, transport
 - o Strengthens supply chain linkages between rural producers, creative designers, and markets

E. Aesthetic and Design Quality

- Clear design identity rooted in cultural narrative
Cohesive presentation and functionality
- Innovation in form, silhouette, pattern reinterpretation, or material combination
- Alignment with professional design standards (Manila FAME, Design Center of the Philippines)

F. Storytelling and Market Readiness

- Has a compelling story: community, material, meaning
- Ready for national or regional market exposure
- Includes packaging, brand identity, or digital presence (even if basic)
- Product can be scaled, replicated, or featured in exhibitions and trade shows (not purely conceptual)

Proposed Recognition Categories

- Best in Cultural Integrity
- Best in Textile Innovation
- Most Climate-Responsive Product

- Women-led Regenerative Enterprise Award
- Emerging Youth Weaver/Designer Award
- Best LGU-Supported Community Product

Philippine Stakeholders Involved :

- Women's Business Council Philippines (WomenBizPH): Coordinate women's sector inter-agency efforts, mobilize funds, and lead advocacy to invite ASEAN Women Entrepreneur Network (AWEN) Member states for the conduct of their National Amazing Weaves Awards
- Department of Trade and Industry (DTI): Activate regional offices, support enterprise development by providing start-up capacity/capability support to the regional and/or national Galing Likha competition qualifying entries in the National Arts & Crafts Fair, and conduct the local competition in collaboration with Galing Pook Foundation (GPK), creative support from the Design Center of the Philippines and
 - o Center for International Trade and Exhibitions (CITEM) to integrate Amazing Weaves into export pathways from design, capability development, campaigns, inclusion in events like MANILA Fame, ASEAN/global creative fairs and government linkages
- Galing Pook Foundation : Local Government Support (LGU) As the implementing partner of the Galing Likha Awards category and the execution of the Amazing Weaves national competition, beginning at the regional level.
- Department of Science and Technology (DOST) Philippine Textile Research Institute Provide a) technical support, b) material yarn requirements, developed with the use of Philippine technology and local materials, and c) collaborate with WomenBizPh in identifying weaving communities that may be endorsed for support of the local government unit (LGU) and other national government agencies (NGAs), as entries in the regional and national competition
- Philippine Commission on Women (PCW): Policy support on Women Economic Empowerment will guide the application of gender inclusion and accessibility lens into the design of the weaving program enabling LGUs to utilize their mandatory 5% GAD budget to fund weaving hubs, skills upgrading and product innovation directly to sustainable livelihoods
- Go Negosyo: Market Access and KapatidMentorMe resources until digital marketing
- Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA) Women Center : Deliver Training
- And other Women Organizations

WomenbizPH Alliance Members :

1. Indian Women Entrepreneurs (I-WE)
2. Philippine Association of Legitimate Service Contractors (PALSCON)
3. Philippine Chamber of Commerce and Industry (PCCI)
4. Philippine Marketing Association (PMA)

5. Philippine Retailers Association (PRA)
6. Women in Tech (Wi-Tech)
7. Employers Confederation of the Philippines (ECOP)
8. Finance Executives Institute (FINEX)
9. FINTECH Alliance
10. InfoComm Technology Association of the Philippines (ITAP)
11. People Management Association of the Philippines (PMAP)
12. International Council for Small Business (ICSB)
13. Management Association of the Philippines (MAP)

Outcomes of ASEAN Amazing Weaves Exhibition

Social

- At least 4 case studies of best practices demonstrating preservation and innovation
- Number of traditional weaving communities represented
- Developed cultural revitalization metrics

Women's Economic Empowerment & Livelihood KPIs (GEWE-aligned)

- Number of women artisans and MSMEs participating
- Percentage of women artisans reporting increased income
- At least 2 weaving hubs established or improved via GAD funding or LGU budget
- Number of women receiving capacity-building training (skills upgrading, product development, business skills)
- Increased in enterprise readiness score (export readiness, market readiness)

Governance

- Number of GAD-funded weaving/enterprise projects initiated
- Number of LGUs applying HGDG in program design

Environmental (Optional for GED Integration)

- Number of enterprises reducing waste or adopting sustainable material
- Number of weaving communities adopting eco-friendly production

Planned Activities Timeline

DATE	Activity	Office Responsible
January to March 2026	Information Sessions	
March 13, 2026	Launch of the Amazing	

DATE	Activity	Office Responsible
	Weaves Selection and Call for Entries	
March 2026	Launch of Amazing Weave among Member States	
June 2026	Deadline for Entries	
July 2026	ASEAN Regional Screening and Shortlisting	
	Provincial Mobilization, Presentations and Screening; eligibility of entries to be validated by the Search Secretariat	
	Selection of Provincial GLA winner	
	Regional Mobilization	
	Regional Presentations of Winners of Provincial GLA winners and Screening; eligibility of entries to be validated by the Search Secretariat	
	Selection of Regional GLA winner	
	National Screening/Selection Committee Mobilization	
August -September 2026	National Presentations of Winners of Regional GLA winners and Screening for the National GLA; eligibility of entries to be validated by	

DATE	Activity	Office Responsible
	the Search Secre ASEAN National Selection by DTI Design Center , Showcase, and ASEAN Exhibition Preparation .	
October 2026	ASEAN Women Economic Summit (AWES) Philippines . ASEAN Pavillion exhibition per member state . ASEAN Hub of Excellence for Women Empowerment and Gender Equality in the Philippines (ASEAN GAD Center)	
November 2026	ASEAN Amazing Weaves Marketplace and Exhbition during ASEAN Women Economic Summit (AWES) Philippines	

Suggested Talking Points for ASEAN Amazing Weaves Stakeholders

1. Why Weaving Matters in Nation-Building

“Weaving is more than a craft—it’s a storybook of our past, a heartbeat of our culture, and a powerful way to stitch together our identity and economy.”

- Weaving supports resilience, identity, and intergenerational pride.
- Cultural heritage has untapped economic potential, especially when women lead.

2. From Craft to Commerce: Empowering Weavers as Entrepreneurs

“Our goal isn’t just to preserve the art, but to grow it into a thriving livelihood—so every thread becomes a source of pride and prosperity.”

- Weavers need business tools, not just tradition.
- Highlight logistics support (e.g., by Airspeed) from community to commerce.

3. Role of Local government and the Private Sector

“When LGUs provide policy and funding—and when businesses invest in scale—our weavers don’t just survive. They thrive.”

- Commend LGUs for ordinances and weaving centers.
- Encourage public-private partnerships in logistics, exhibitions, and digital access.

4. Job Creation through Trade and Job Fairs

“Trade fairs and job fairs are bridges—connecting creativity to commerce, and pride to prosperity.”

- Promote direct-to-buyer models and diaspora appeal.
- Suggest youth engagement in weaving via tech and tourism integration.

5. SMEs and the Global Market

“SMEs don’t lack creativity—they just need the platform to scale.”

- Propose bundling export support (logistics, compliance, mentoring).
- Position textiles as cultural exports for ASEAN pride and identity.

Theme : Stitching ASEAN Legacy with Livelihood

“With the ASEAN Amazing Weaves Competition, we are not only weaving cloth. We are weaving a future that honors our past, uplifts our present, and inspires generations to come.”